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. As Abul Fazl put it, ‘According to the religion of sovereignty and the canons of world-conquest, contentment (or moderation) in regard to the subjugation of countries is blameworthy and disapproved of, just as covetousness is in ascetics.’ *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. In a carefully worded letter to Abdullah of Turan, written in 1586, Akbar declared that ‘Places which from the time of [the] rise of the sun of Islam . . . had not been trod by the horse-hoofs of world-conquering princes and where their swords had never flashed have become the . . . homes of the faithful’. He went on to write that temples of the ‘infidels and heretics have become mosques and holy shrines for the masters of orthodoxy’ – a claim at which Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi, at least, would have scoffed. By contrast, at a feast in Akbar’s court in 1590, two clerics drank wine and Akbar recited a little verse for the occasion: ‘In the era of the fault-forgiving king / The Qazi drained flagons, the Mufti quaffed cups.’ See *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. See Joel Lee’s essay on the evolution of the term ‘halalkhor’ from Akbar’s age to the present day (Joel Lee, ‘Who is the True Halalkhor? Genealogy and Ethics in Dalit Muslim Oral Traditions’, *Contributions to Indian Sociology*, vol. 52, no. 1, 2018). Abul Fazl, describing the various ranks of employees in the imperial stables, writes of the sweepers that they are called ‘halalkhur’ and that ‘His Majesty brought this name en vogue’. See Abu’l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. It is debatable whether either Akbar or Gandhi wanted to bring about such radical systemic change. Gandhi’s essay on ‘The Ideal Bhangi’ is notorious, and Akbar, again, may have anticipated some of its sentiments when he said: ‘In the struggle to maintain universal order it may be appropriate for one person to be a sweeper and another a dog keeper in order for them to be safe from the temptations of the flesh and to keep their minds pure.’ See Abu’l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 5, trans. W.M. Thackston. Henry Beveridge did not translate the reams of advice of which these lines are a part, arguing that the discourse held ‘nothing . . . characteristic of Akbar’.
. Iqtidar Alam Khan writes that the fact that Akbar’s ‘fits’ stopped after 1578 or so, ‘when Akbar had developed a new world view identified with sulh-i kul, goes to suggest that these had something to do with the mental tensions of the earlier phase of his life’. See Iqtidar Alam Khan, ‘Akbar’s Personality Traits and World Outlook: A Critical Appraisal’, in *Akbar and His India*, ed. Irfan Habib (Oxford University Press, 1997).
. Stephen F. Dale, *The Muslim Empires of the Ottomans, Safavids, and Mughals* (Cambridge University Press, 2010). Joseph E. Schwartzberg’s *A Historical Atlas of South Asia* includes a detailed map of the expansion of Akbar’s empire. It is available to view on the Digital South Asia Library: http://www.columbia.edu/itc/mealac/pritchett/00maplinks/mughal/dsal/dsal.html
. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 2.